

About Validation State Governance Standard

Governing Validation as a Current Lifecycle State Rather Than a

Permanent Label

Validation happens at a point in time.

Systems continue to change.

Models change.

Data changes.

Configurations change.

Operating environments change.

Dependencies change.

Risks change.

And the meaning of a historical validation conclusion can change with them.

Validation State Governance Standard (VSGS) is the ninth Parent Standard of **VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture**, governing the formal lifecycle condition that a Validation Object currently holds after considering applicable Validation Determinations, object continuity, version, scope, conditions, validity periods, material change, and revalidation requirements.

VSGS addresses one fundamental question:

What Validation State does the Validation Object hold now?

Why Validation State Governance Standard Exists

A validation process may legitimately determine that an object satisfies its Validation Criteria.

But that conclusion does not exist outside time.

After determination:

- the object may change,
- software may be updated,
- the model may be retrained,
- dependencies may change,
- evidence may age,
- source reliability may change,
- new failures may be discovered,
- operational conditions may drift,
- or the original validation period may simply expire.

If historical validation remains permanently attached to the object despite these changes, the word:

Validated

gradually loses methodological meaning.

VSGS exists to prevent that.

Determination Is Not State

VALIDOS® creates a deliberate separation between:

Validation Determination

and:

Validation State

A Validation Determination answers:

What did a specific governed validation event demonstrate?

A Validation State answers:

What validation condition does the Validation Object currently hold?

A determination is a conclusion.

A state is a lifecycle condition.

Therefore:

Validation Determination ≠ Validation State

This separation allows historical validation conclusions to remain accurate records even when the current status of the object changes.

Why This Distinction Matters

Suppose a system receives a Positive Validation Determination on 1 January.

The determination remains historically true:

The system version examined on 1 January satisfied the applicable Validation Criteria under the validated conditions.

But six months later the system may have:

- changed architecture,
 - changed data,
-

- changed operating environment,
- changed configuration,
- experienced a critical incident,
- or exceeded its defined validation period.

The historical determination does not disappear.

The current Validation State may change.

That is precisely what VSGS governs.

From Validation Event to Validation Lifecycle

The VALIDOS® lifecycle has now reached:

Validation Object

↓

Validation Purpose & Scope

↓

Validation Criteria

↓

Validation Method

↓

Validation Evidence Fitness

↓

Validation Source Reliability ↓

Validation Execution

↓

Validation Determination

↓

Validation State

The first eight Parent Standards establish what was validated and what the governed validation event demonstrated.

VSGS extends that conclusion through time.

Validation Is Not a Permanent Property

VALIDOS® rejects the assumption:

Validated Once = Validated Forever

Validation is not a permanent characteristic like an immutable identity attribute.

It is a governed condition whose continued applicability depends upon whether the basis supporting it remains materially valid.

Therefore:

Validation must have lifecycle governance.

A Validation State Is More Than a Label

A governed Validation State should remain connected to:

- the Validation Object,
- object version,
- applicable Validation Determination,
- Validation Purpose,
- Validation Scope,
- Validation Depth,
- conditions,
- restrictions,
- limitations,
- effective point,
- validity period,
- material-change triggers,
- state-transition history,
- and revalidation requirements.

Without these relationships, a state such as:

Validated

says very little.

Canonical Validation States

VALIDOS® may distinguish formal states including:

Validation Required Validation Pending

Partially Validated

Conditionally Validated

Validated

Validation Conflicted

Validation Suspended

Invalidated

Validation Expired

Revalidation Required

These states represent materially different validation conditions.

They should not be collapsed into a binary:

Valid / Invalid

Validation Required

A Validation Object may begin in:

Validation Required

This means that an applicable validation basis has not yet been sufficiently established for the intended governed purpose.

It does not imply failure.

It means validation must occur before an applicable Validation State can be established.

Validation Pending

Validation Pending indicates that validation activity is underway, scheduled, or otherwise progressing but has not yet produced the determination required for a stable state.

This prevents:

Validation has started

from being represented as:

Validation has succeeded

Partially Validated

Complex Validation Objects may not possess one uniform validation condition.

For example:

- one subsystem may be validated,
- another may remain unvalidated,
- one population may be covered,
- another may not,
- one operating mode may be validated,
- another may remain uncertain.

Where those boundaries are methodologically separable, VSGS allows:

Partially Validated

rather than forcing a misleading global label.

Conditionally Validated

A system may be validated only while particular conditions remain true.

For example:

- human override remains available,
- a specified safety control remains active,
- operation remains within a defined range,
- a particular configuration remains unchanged,
- a restricted population is used,
- or specific monitoring remains active.

In these cases, the correct current state may be:

Conditionally Validated

The condition is not a footnote.

It is part of the state itself.

Validated

Validated means that the Validation Object currently possesses an applicable positive validation basis within its governed:

- object version,
- purpose,
- scope,
- depth,
- conditions,
- and validity period.

It does not mean:

Universally Valid

Valid for Every Use

Valid Forever

or:

Approved for Deployment

The state must remain bounded.

Validation Conflicted

A Validation Object may possess materially incompatible current validation signals.

For example:

- two legitimate determinations conflict,
- different operating environments support incompatible conclusions,
- new evidence materially challenges the current state,
- or different validated portions cannot yet be reconciled.

In such cases, VALIDOS® may represent:

Validation Conflicted

rather than hiding disagreement behind one simplified status.

Validation Suspended

A currently active Validation State may need temporary suspension.

Possible triggers include:

- new safety information,
- critical incident,
- questioned evidence integrity,
- Source Reliability reassessment,
- material object change,
- determination suspension,
- investigation,
- or unresolved anomaly.

Suspension means:

**The previous validation basis has not necessarily been destroyed,
but current applicability cannot presently be treated**

as unrestricted.

Suspension Is Not Invalidation

This distinction matters.

Validation Suspended

means:

Current validation applicability is temporarily unresolved or restricted.

Invalidated

means:

The basis supporting the prior state has been materially destroyed or is no longer legitimately applicable.

Therefore:

Suspended ≠ Invalidated

Invalidated

Invalidation may occur where the validation basis is fundamentally undermined.

Examples may include:

- critical object change,
- invalid underlying determination,
- compromised decisive evidence,
- major Source Reliability failure,
- fundamental methodological error,
- or new evidence demonstrating that the prior validation basis cannot remain legitimate.

Invalidation may apply to the entire object or only a defined part.

Validation Expired

Validation can also cease to be current without any failure.

A Validation State may simply reach the end of its valid period.

VALIDOS® therefore establishes:

Validation Expired ≠ Validation Failed

Expiration means:

The previous validation basis can no longer be assumed current without renewal or revalidation.

Revalidation Required

A Validation Object enters:

Revalidation Required

where the previous validation basis is no longer sufficient to support the required current assurance.

Triggers may include:

- material object change,
- scope expansion,
- new use case,
- new operating environment,
- expiration,
- significant drift,
- new risk,
- changed regulation,
- new critical evidence,
- or unresolved suspension.

Revalidation Required does not automatically mean that the object is invalid.

It means that the old validation basis is insufficient for the current governance question.

Current State and Historical State Are Different

VALIDOS® preserves both.

For example:

Historical State: Validated

Current State: Revalidation Required

These statements are not contradictory.

The first describes history.

The second describes current applicability.

This distinction creates validation continuity across time.

Validation State Is Object-Specific

State must remain attached to the exact Validation Object.

Where version matters:

Validated Version 3.2

does not automatically imply:

Validated Version 3.3

The significance of the difference depends upon whether the change is materially relevant to validation.

Material Change Is the Critical Lifecycle Question

One of the most important VSGS questions is:

Has the Validation Object changed enough that the current Validation State can no longer be assumed applicable?

Not every change matters.

A typo in documentation may be irrelevant.

A model retraining may be highly material.

A minor software patch may or may not matter depending upon what changed.

VSGS therefore requires **Material Change Assessment** rather than assuming either:

Every change requires complete revalidation

or:

No change matters unless failure occurs

Material Change Can Take Many Forms

Validation-relevant change may involve:

- object identity,
 - model architecture,
 - model weights,
 - training data,
 - dataset composition,
 - software,
 - hardware,
 - system configuration,
 - operating environment,
 - population,
 - dependencies,
 - interfaces,
-

- permissions,
- autonomous authority,
- jurisdiction,
- intended use,
- or risk profile.

The significance of change depends upon the governed validation basis.

Validation Equivalence

After change, VSGS may ask:

Is the changed object still sufficiently equivalent to the object that was validated?

Possible outcomes include:

Validation Equivalence Maintained

Validation Equivalence Conditionally Maintained

Validation Equivalence Undetermined

Validation Equivalence Lost

This allows proportionate lifecycle governance.

Not Every Change Requires Full Revalidation

VALIDOS® should remain operationally usable.

If every minor modification automatically forced complete validation from the beginning, validation governance could become unnecessarily rigid.

VSGS therefore allows change to trigger proportionate responses such as:

- state maintained,
- conditional state,
- targeted reassessment,
- partial revalidation,
- full revalidation,
- or suspension.

The response should correspond to the validation significance of the change.

State Validity Can Be Time-Based

Some validations naturally require expiration periods.

For example:

- calibration-dependent validation,
- rapidly changing AI models,
- dynamic cybersecurity environments,
- medical systems,
- financial models,
- or other contexts where historical validation loses relevance quickly.

A state may therefore include a fixed expiration date or maximum duration.

State Validity Can Also Be Event-Based

Other validation states may remain valid until a defined event occurs.

For example:

Valid until model retraining

Valid until configuration change

Valid while Safety Control X remains active

Valid until operating scope expands This may be more appropriate than arbitrary calendar expiration.

State Validity Can Be Continuously Governed

Some Validation Objects may require continuous or near-continuous state monitoring.

For example:

- adaptive AI systems,
- high-autonomy systems,
- financial prediction systems,
- critical infrastructure,
- or systems with rapid operational drift.

In these environments, Validation State may be maintained dynamically.

State Monitoring Does Not Equal Revalidation

Monitoring identifies whether state conditions remain satisfied.

It may detect:

- object change,
- configuration drift,
- incidents,
- new evidence,
- source changes,
- threshold crossings,
- environmental changes,
- or approaching expiration.

Monitoring itself does not automatically establish a new validation conclusion.

Validation State Drift

Some objects may change gradually.

There may be no single dramatic event.

Instead:

- data distribution changes,
- users change,
- environments shift,
- dependencies evolve,
- repeated patches accumulate,
- or system behavior drifts.

VSGS therefore recognizes **Validation State Drift** as a lifecycle problem.

Repeated small changes may collectively become material.

A Thousand Small Changes Can Become One Material Change

A system may undergo hundreds of individually minor modifications.

Individually, none may justify revalidation.

Collectively, they may produce a system materially different from the one originally validated.

VSGS therefore permits cumulative change assessment.

State Conditions Must Remain Visible

If an object is:

Conditionally Validated

the conditions supporting that state must remain attached throughout the lifecycle.

If one condition disappears, the state may need to change.

For example:

Conditionally Validated with continuous human oversight

cannot remain unchanged after human oversight is removed.

State Restrictions Must Survive

Restrictions define where the state must not be generalized.

Examples include:

- not validated for autonomous operation,
- not validated outside Europe,
- not validated for pediatric use,
- not validated under degraded network conditions,
- or not validated beyond Version 2.5.

Restrictions should survive state transitions unless explicitly reassessed.

State Limitations Must Survive

A validation state may remain active while carrying known limitations.

For example:

- limited long-term evidence,
- limited edge-case evidence,
- limited external validation,
- limited population coverage,
- or unresolved low-frequency uncertainty.

VSGS preserves these limitations as part of the current validation context.

State Transition Must Be Governed

Validation states should not change arbitrarily.

A transition requires an identifiable basis.

Examples include:

Validation Required → Validation Pending

because validation has started.

Validation Pending → Validated

because a sufficient Positive Validation Determination exists.

Validated → Validation Suspended

because material uncertainty emerged.

Validated → Revalidation Required

because the object materially changed.

Revalidation Required → Validation Pending

because a new validation cycle has begun.

State Transitions Should Be Traceable

Every material transition should answer:

What state existed before?

What event triggered change?

What evidence supported the transition?

Who or what authorized it where required?

When did the new state become effective?

This creates a validation lifecycle history.

Validation State Can Be Multidimensional

A complex object may legitimately have several simultaneous validation dimensions.

For example:

Performance: Validated

Safety: Conditionally Validated

Autonomy: Revalidation Required

Cybersecurity: Validation Pending

One global label could obscure important differences.

VSGS therefore allows multidimensional state representation where needed.

State Hierarchy

Complex systems may also require state hierarchy:

Component → Subsystem → System

A system-level state must remain traceable to the validation states of the components upon which it depends.

A validated component does not automatically make the full system Validated.

Likewise, one unvalidated component may or may not control the entire system state depending upon its significance.

State Precedence

Where several states overlap, some states may need precedence for current representation.

For example:

A system historically carrying:

Validated

may currently need to be represented as:

Validation Suspended

if a critical investigation is underway.

Historical validation remains visible, but the current operational validation status must reflect the suspension.

Determination Change Can Trigger State Change

If the governing Validation Determination changes from:

Positive

to:

Conditional

the current Validation State may need to transition from:

Validated

to:

Conditionally Validated

If the determination is withdrawn, the state may require suspension, invalidation, or revalidation.

Determination governance and state governance therefore remain distinct but connected.

State Reassessment

VSGS provides a formal process for asking whether the current state remains appropriate.

Reassessment may result in:

State Maintained

State Restricted

State Made Conditional

State Suspended

State Expired

State Invalidated

Revalidation Required

or:

New State Assigned

State Reassessment Can Be Triggered by New Evidence

A Validation Object does not need to change physically for its state to change.

New evidence may show that:

- an assumption was wrong,
- a previously unknown failure mode exists,
- a source was unreliable,
- a validation method contained a defect,
- or a critical operational condition was not represented.

Current state must therefore respond to changes in knowledge as well

as changes in the object.

State Reassessment Can Be Triggered by New Reality

Similarly, the surrounding environment may change while the object remains unchanged.

Examples include:

- new cyber threats,
- new regulations,
- changed populations,
- new operating environments,
- new infrastructure dependencies,
- or new use cases.

Validation is always relative to a governed context.

Revalidation Is a Lifecycle Mechanism

Revalidation should not be viewed merely as repeating the original validation.

It is a governed response to the fact that validation applicability changes over time.

Revalidation may be:

- complete,
- partial,
- targeted,
- criterion-specific,
- scope-specific,
- change-specific,
- or risk-triggered.

The final VALIDOS® Parent Standard will govern the full revalidation lifecycle.

State Continuity Creates Validation Memory

VSGS preserves:

Past State

Current State Transition

Trigger

Determination Basis

Conditions

Revalidation History

This creates a validation history for the object.

A future validator can understand not only:

Is this object validated?

but:

How did its validation condition evolve?

Validation State Should Be Machine-Readable

For AI, autonomous systems, digital infrastructure, and automated governance, Validation State should be representable in a machine-readable form.

A machine-readable state may allow systems to determine:

- current state,
- applicable scope,
- expiration,
- restrictions,
- required revalidation,
- object version,
- and conditions.

This creates potential for runtime validation governance.

A System Could Query Its Own Validation State

In mature VALIDOS® implementations, an autonomous system or operational platform could theoretically determine:

Current Validation State: Conditionally Validated

Valid Scope: Environment A

Restriction: Human Override Required

Expiration: 30 September

Revalidation Trigger: Model Update

This transforms validation from a static report into operational governance infrastructure.

Validation State Is Not Reliance

Even after all of this, one final question remains.

A system may be currently:

Validated

but that does not mean every actor may rely upon it for every purpose.

The next Parent Standard must govern:

Who may rely?

For what purpose?

Under what conditions?

For how long?

What happens when validation changes?

Therefore:

Validated State ≠ Reliance Authorization

Validation State Is Not Deployment Authorization

A Validated state also does not automatically permit deployment.

Deployment may require separate:

- legal approval,
- risk acceptance,
- governance authority,
- safety approval,
- organizational readiness,
- or operational authorization.

VALIDOS® governs validation.

It does not collapse validation into every other governance decision.

Position Within VALIDOS®

Validation State Governance Standard is the ninth Parent Standard of **VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture.**

Its architectural position is:

**Validation Object → Validation Purpose & Scope → Validation Criteria
→ Validation Method → Validation Evidence Fitness → Validation
Source Reliability → Validation Execution → Validation Determination
→ Validation State → Validation Reliance & Revalidation**

The eighth Parent Standard establishes:

What the validation demonstrated.

The ninth establishes:

What current validation condition the object holds.

The tenth will establish:

When and how that state may legitimately be relied upon and when new validation becomes necessary.

Relationship to Other OOF® Architectures

VSGS operates alongside complementary OOF® architectures.

GOA™ may establish authority governing state assignment, transitions, suspension, invalidation, and reactivation.

OBIDENTITY® may preserve object identity, version continuity, ownership, provenance, and transfer relationships.

INTEGROS® may establish integrity conditions affecting whether the validation basis remains trustworthy.

ORA™ may identify changes in operational reality affecting current state applicability.

AGA™ may establish accountability for state monitoring, assignment, transition, and reassessment.

RIS™ may influence the sensitivity of Validation State change triggers according to risk and consequence.

AIG®, CLIA®, MGIA™, and **ASGA™** may contribute specialized change signals where AI behavior, cognition, memory, or autonomous capability affects current validation applicability.

VSGS does not duplicate these architectures.

It asks one specific lifecycle question:

What Validation State does the Validation Object legitimately hold now?

Why It Matters

Without Validation State Governance, validation becomes historical documentation.

A report says:

Validated in 2026.

But nobody can answer:

Is it still validated?

Did the object change?

Did the conditions change?

Did the validation expire?

Was a critical incident discovered?

Does the current version still correspond to the validated version?

Is revalidation required?

VSGS transforms validation from an event into a lifecycle-governed condition.

From “Was Validated” to “Is Currently Validated”

This is the central transformation of VSGS.

Traditional validation often establishes:

Was Validated

VSGS governs:

Is Currently in Validation State X

These are fundamentally different levels of methodological maturity.

From Static Certificate to Dynamic Validation State

A certificate is static.

Operational reality is dynamic.

VALIDOS® therefore creates the methodological possibility of moving from:

Static Validation Record

toward:

Dynamic Validation State Governance

This becomes increasingly important as systems themselves become adaptive, autonomous, continuously updated, and interconnected.

The Validation Lifecycle Becomes Visible

With VSGS, VALIDOS® can represent:

Validation Required

↓

Validation Pending

↓

Validated

↓

Material Change

↓

Revalidation Required

↓

Validation Pending

↓

Conditionally Validated

↓

New Evidence

↓

Validation Suspended

↓

Reassessment

↓

Validated

This is validation as a governed lifecycle rather than a one-time event.

Foundational Principle

Validation is not a permanent property of an object; it is a governed state that must remain connected to the object, conditions, evidence, and reality that continue to justify it.

Canonical Closing Statement

Validation State Governance Standard establishes the lifecycle-state layer of VALIDOS® — Validation Governance Architecture by transforming validation determinations into current, bounded, condition-aware, time-aware, change-aware, and traceable Validation States. Through governance of state assignment, scope, depth, conditions, restrictions, limitations, effective points, validity periods, material change, equivalence, monitoring, drift, suspension, invalidation, expiration, revalidation triggers, partial and multidimensional validation, transitions, reassessment, supersession, and historical continuity, VSGS ensures that validation remains connected not merely to what an object once demonstrated, but to whether the current object and the current reality still justify representing that validation as active.

Parent Resources

→ [VALIDOS® Architecture Map](#)

→ [VALIDOS® Complete Standards & Modules Index](#)

Related Documents

→ [Validation State Governance Standard](#)

→ [VALIDOS® Validation Governance Architecture — Validation Governance Layer](#)

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